

AI-Augmented Stakeholder Prep

Week 6 • Day 4 • Stakeholder Alignment & Negotiation

TPM Academy



Day 4 Objectives

- Use AI to assemble a **prior-context summary** — with validation
- Predict the stakeholder's **top 5 objections** with response + pivot + line-we-hold
- Write and **rehearse a 60-second opening**
- Identify **1–3 non-negotiables** with fallbacks
- Run a **mock meeting** with another triad in role



Today's Shape

Clock	Block	Outcome
09:00 – 09:15	Opening	Pin the "5 most consequential asks" + Day 3 brief
09:15 – 10:30	Block 1 + Activity 1	Prior-context summary + validation
10:45 – 12:00	Block 2 + Activity 2	Objection map (5 objections + responses)
13:00 – 14:15	Block 3 + Activity 3	Opening + non-negotiables
14:30 – 16:00	Block 4 + Activity 4 + Wrap	Cross-review + mock meeting

Block 1 — Prior Context

AI assembles; the human validates

AI in Meeting Prep

AI does well	AI does poorly
Re-organize content you provide	Tell you what's been decided
Suggest predictable objections	Predict who in the room you've never met
Draft an opening you edit	Decide the opening tone
Identify gaps in coverage	Verify facts against current production

The discipline: AI does specific structured tasks under explicit constraints; every output gets validated.

Two-Prompt Pattern

A. Assemble context

Pull from PRD/TCD/TMD/SEP excerpts. Output: prior decisions / open questions / past tension, with citations.

B. Find gaps

What's likely to come up that the documented context does NOT cover? 3 gaps + suggested research.

```
A. Role: Project archivist for a TPM.  
Context: <relevant prd="" tcd="" tmd="" sep="" excerpts="">  
Task: Prior-context summary –  
1. Prior decisions made (with section reference)  
2. Open questions remaining  
3. Tension surfaced (if any) with reference  
Constraints: only provided content; cite sections; "none documented" if N/A.</relevant>
```

Activity 1 — Prior-Context Summary

Triads • 35 minutes

- 5 min: identify the topic (from "5 most consequential")
- 10 min: run Prompt A
- 15 min: validate citations (cross-check or spot-check)
- 5 min: run Prompt B (gaps)



5 + 10 + 15 + 5

Block 2 — Objection Map

5 predicted objections; honest response; pivot; line we hold



Objection Response Template

```
### Objection N: <short name="">
**The stakeholder says:** <quoted, in="" their="" voice="">
**The honest response:** <what's actually="" true;="" do="" not="" over-promise="">
**The pivot (if pushback continues):** <where to="" redirect="" --="" usually="" a="" deeper="" "why"="" or="" documented="" trade-of
**The line we hold:** <if this="" objection="" wins,="" what's="" the="" smallest="" ground="" we="" give="" up?=""></if></where></w
```

"The line we hold" is the senior-author signal. It's specific. Not "we'd compromise."

Objection-Map Prompt

```
Role: <stakeholder type="" --"" e.g.,="" compliance="" lead,="" architect="">
Context: <day 3="" brief="" +="" relevant="" tcd="" tmd="" excerpts="">
Task: Read as the named stakeholder. List your top 5 objections,
ranked by intensity.
Constraints:
- Specific to the brief, not generic
- Voice the stakeholder honestly – not a strawman
- At least 1 objection should be hostile (the one you'd push hardest)
Format: 5 numbered objections in the stakeholder's likely tone.</day></stakeholder>
```

Activity 2 — Objection Map

Triads • 40 minutes

- 10 min: AI generates 5 objections
- 10 min: validate (realistic? hostile enough?)
- 15 min: write response/pivot/line per objection
- 5 min: identify highest-stakes objection



10 + 10 + 15 + 5

Block 3 — Opening + Non-Negotiables

60 seconds; rehearsed; few specific lines you won't cross



The 4-Part Opening

1. **Why we're meeting** (1 sentence)
2. **What's at stake for them** (1 sentence in their currency)
3. **What you're asking for** (1 sentence — concrete decision)
4. **Acknowledgment of past tension** (1 sentence; only if needed)

Practiced, not improvised. Read it aloud twice. Time it. If > 75 seconds, cut.



Non-Negotiables

1–3 things you cannot give up. Knowing them in advance is the defense against folding under pressure.

- **Specific:** "We will not compromise on audit-trail retention" — not "we won't compromise on quality"
- **Few:** 3 max. More than 3 = you'll fold tomorrow.
- **Each has a fallback:** what we'd give up to protect it

Common rookie error: 6+ non-negotiables. Stakeholder tests one; rookie folds; rookie folds on others by association.

Activity 3 — Opening + Non-Negotiables

Triads • 40 minutes

- 15 min: draft 4-part opening
- 10 min: rehearse aloud twice + time it
- 10 min: identify 1–3 non-negotiables
- 5 min: pick fallback for each



15 + 10 + 10 + 5

Block 4 — Mock Meeting

Run the opening; receive 1–2 objections; capture what threw you



Mock Meeting Structure

1. **Pair triads** (same as Day 3)
2. **Triad A opens** (5 min) — gives opening; reviewer raises 1–2 objections in role
3. **Pause + capture** (5 min) — what worked; what threw you
4. **Switch roles** (5 min)
5. **Pause + capture** (5 min)
6. **Each triad updates §4** with: opening tweak, harder-than-expected objection, "I wish I'd said"

AI Cross-Check on the Whole Packet

Role: Negotiation coach reviewing a meeting-prep packet.

Context: <paste the="" \$4="" packet="" --="" opening,="" objection="" map,="" non-negotiables="">

Task: Identify 3 gaps in the prep:

1. An objection probably under-prepared
2. A non-negotiable that's actually negotiable (or absent)
3. A part of the opening likely to sound rehearsed in a bad way

Constraints:

- Be specific
- Suggest a concrete fix

Format: 3 numbered findings.</paste>

Activity 4 — Mock Meeting + AI Cross-Check

Triad pairs • 45 minutes • Wrap

- 5 min: pair set-up
- 10 min: round 1 (opening + objections)
- 5 min: capture
- 10 min: round 2 (swap)
- 5 min: capture
- 10 min: AI cross-check + update §4



5 + 10 + 5 + 10 + 5 + 10 · 15-min wrap



Day 4 Wrap

What we built

- Validated prior-context summary
- 5-objection map with response/pivot/line
- 60-second opening (rehearsed)
- 1–3 non-negotiables with fallbacks
- Mock-meeting feedback
- SEP §4 drafted

What opens tomorrow

- **Live negotiation simulations** — 3 rounds
- Architecture / SLO round
- Scope round
- Resource / timeline round
- Outcomes log + sign-off

Bring to Day 5: SEP §§1–4 + the mock-meeting captures. Tomorrow you negotiate live.



Questions & Reflection

Where did the AI's prediction surprise you most?